GENS HRMS: Feature Analysis & Roadmap

Compared against the Indian HRMS market | October 2026

1. What GENS is

GENS is a multi-tenant SaaS HRMS for Indian SMBs. The backend is Node/Express with Sequelize and Postgres, and the frontend is Angular. It has a superadmin panel, subscription plans, Razorpay checkout and a marketing site. Its closest competitors are **Keka, greytHR, Zoho People/Payroll, HROne, factoHR, Qandle, sumHR** and, at the enterprise end, **Darwinbox**.

2. What's already built

Area	What exists	Status
Core HR	Employee master, profile, documents, letters (offer, appointment, NDA, relieving), templates, letterhead	Strong
Attendance	Upload, shifts, regularization, comp-off, holidays, weekends, contractual approval	Strong
Leave	Master, balance, ledger, apply/approve	Good
Payroll	Salary setup, allowances, deductions, arrears, full- and part-time pay, reimbursements, payslip order, salary register	Good
Recruitment / ATS	Jobs, candidates, pipeline board, ATS score, interview rounds, interviewer panel, feedback, offers, BGV tracker	Very strong (Keka and greytHR are weaker here)
Self-service	Employee portal, mobile app API with FCM push notifications	Good
Field tracking	Live GPS tracking, device location logs	A real advantage for field-workforce customers
AI insights	Attrition, payroll check, leave suggestions, performance, recruitment assistant	Partial: frontend only, calls a separate AI service
Appraisal	Basic appraisal list and employee appraisal	Basic
SaaS layer	Tenants, plans, subscriptions, audit log, role permissions	Present

3. Must-have features (expected by every Indian buyer)

3.1 Statutory payroll compliance (biggest gap)

Every competitor ships this, and buyers walk away without it.

- PF, ESI, Professional Tax (state-wise slabs) and LWF. PF and ESI appear only in a few files, Professional Tax only in the frontend, and LWF nowhere.
- TDS on salary with old/new regime selection, investment declarations and proofs, and Form 16 / 24Q. TDS today is only a report bucket.
- Statutory challans and returns: ECR file for EPFO, ESIC return, and a bank transfer advice file.
- Gratuity calculation, which doesn't exist yet.

3.2 Employee exit and full-and-final settlement

- Resignation, notice period, clearance checklist, F&F calculation (leave encashment, gratuity, recoveries) and relieving letter.
- The relieving letter already exists, but the workflow around it doesn't.

3.3 Onboarding workflow

- Offer-to-joining handover with pre-joining document collection and a task checklist.
- The ATS pieces are there; the link between ATS and the employee record is missing.

3.4 Payroll lock and approval workflow

- Monthly run, then review, then lock, then publish payslips, with no edits after lock.
- Maker-checker approval and payroll audit history.

3.5 Attendance hardware and mobile

- Biometric device integration (eSSL / ZKTeco).
- Geofenced clock-in and selfie or face verification. GPS data is already collected, so geofencing is a small step.

3.6 Security and data protection

Mandatory before selling to anyone; the DPDP Act 2023 makes several of these legal requirements in India.

- Passwords are hashed with **unsalted SHA-256** (`controller/auth/login.js`). Switch to bcrypt or argon2.
- The employee-portal JWT has **no expiry** (`controller/tenant/employeePortal.js`).
- **281 uploaded files are committed to git**, including resumes and `gensBackend.zip`. That is personal data in the repository history.
- The `upload` folder is served publicly with no auth check (`server.js`).
- No rate limiting or helmet on login/OTP; request body limit is 100 MB.
- No automated tests: the 116 `.spec.ts` files are Angular's default stubs.
- DPDP: consent records, data deletion on request, and a data retention policy.

3.7 Reports and exports

- Custom report builder, scheduled email reports, and Excel/PDF export of every list.

4. Should-have features (to compete with Keka, greytHR, Zoho)

Feature	Why it matters
Performance management: OKRs/KPIs, 360° feedback, review cycles, 9-box grid	Keka and Darwinbox win deals on this; current appraisal module is basic
Expense management: policy limits, receipt OCR, multi-level approval	Reimbursement exists, which is half of this
Timesheets and project tracking	Required by IT services and agency customers
Asset management: allocation, return at exit, history	Cheap to build and widely expected
Helpdesk / ticketing for employee queries to HR	Standard in Keka, Zoho and HROne
Engagement: announcements, surveys, polls, recognition wall, birthdays/anniversaries	Drives daily active usage
WhatsApp bot for leave, payslip and attendance	Strong in India; HROne and factoHR push it hard
Configurable approval workflow engine (multi-level, conditional)	Needed for anything above about 100 employees
Integrations: Tally/Zoho Books, bank payout (RazorpayX), Google/Microsoft SSO, Slack/Teams, Naukri/LinkedIn	Integrations close deals
Org chart and employee directory	Expected baseline UI
Multi-language (Hindi plus regional)	Needed for blue-collar and field customers

5. Where GENS can stand out

1. Real AI built into the product, not a separate tab. The AI screens exist but depend on an outside service. Make them work end to end:

- Resume parsing and JD matching on top of the existing candidate ATS score.
- Payroll anomaly detection before the payroll lock.
- HR policy chatbot answering from the handbook (chatbot widget and handbook module already exist).

- Attrition risk with suggested actions.
- Natural-language reports, e.g. "show late-comers in Pune branch last month".

2. A field-workforce suite. Combine live tracking, geofence, visit logs, route history and travel allowance auto-calculated from distance. Keka and greytHR are weak here; this is the strongest angle against them.

3. Recruitment-to-payroll in one product. Most SMB tools need a separate ATS. Sell the full journey: ATS, offer, onboarding, payroll.

4. Pricing for small teams (10-50 employees) with a free tier. greytHR and Keka get expensive at small sizes.

6. Recommended roadmap

Phase	Focus
P0 (now)	Security fixes (3.6), statutory compliance (PF/ESI/PT/TDS/Form 16), payroll lock and approval
P1	Exit and F&F, onboarding workflow, geofence and biometric, workflow engine, Tally and bank integration
P2	Performance (OKR/360), expense, timesheets, assets, helpdesk
P3 (differentiators)	AI built into the product, field-workforce suite, WhatsApp bot, engagement

Bottom line

Recruitment and attendance are already competitive. Statutory payroll compliance and the security fixes are the two things that would block a sale today, so do those first. After that, the field-workforce features and built-in AI give GENS something Keka and greytHR don't have.